COURSE

## IB Diploma Programme Business management HL

# Product portfolio

**Unit 4: Marketing · 4.5 The seven Ps of the marketing mix: product**

Revision for Unit 4: Marketing: each firm works it out on its own deals.

| Class | Topic |
|---|---|
| **IB Diploma Programme Business management HL** | **Product portfolio** |

THE LESSON

**Setup** — 2 min

**Round 1** — Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Firm decisions** | **Deals** | TASK 1 **BCG category** | TASK 2 **A balanced range** |

**Round 2** — Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 2 min

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Firm decisions** | **Deals** | TASK 3 **Rank market growth** | TASK 4 **Growth and share** | **B2B deal** |

**Round 3** — Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 2 min

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Firm decisions** | **Deals** | TASK 5 **Where cash goes** | TASK 6 **Risk in the range** | **B2B deal** |

**Final questions** — 3 min

45-minute setting shown. The 30-minute setting has one topic task per round (Tasks 3, 5 and 6) and one B2B deal. 60 and 75 add more deals.

# Each step

| | |
|---|---|
| **Firm decisions** | Each role makes its decision on its own page. |
| **Deals** | Each pupil trades with a classmate in another firm. |
| **Topic task** | The firm answers together. Everyone presses Agree. |
| **B2B deal** | One firm sells a lot of cars to another firm. |
| **Final questions** | Each pupil answers six questions. |

# Firm decisions

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **CEO** | **Staff** | Hire staff. Each costs a salary and gives one benefit. |
| | **Sabotage** FROM ROUND 2 | Hit a rival firm's cash, at a cost. A Legal Counsel blocks it. |
| **Sales & Marketing** | **Marketing** | Book one advert campaign to lift the next sales. |
| **Finance** | **Capital & Loans** | Borrow cash. The firm pays it back with interest. |
| | **Investments** | Buy property or funds. The value can rise or fall. |
| **Operations** | **Buying** | Hire the Procurement Specialist or the Stock Controller for the round. |

**B2B deal · Rounds 2 and 3**

One firm sells a lot of 3 cars to another firm (4 in Round 3). With an odd number of firms, two firms offer to sell and the lower price wins.

# Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same for every firm.

## Task 1

ROUND 1

Your newest model has 5% of a market growing 20% a year. The leader has 40%.

**Which BCG matrix category is this?**

PICK ONE

- ○ Cash cow
- ○ Dog
- ✔ **Question mark**
- ○ Star

**Why:** A low share of a high-growth market is a question mark, not a star.

## Task 2

ROUND 1

You want a balanced range of models.

**Which two should the range include?**

PICK TWO

- ✔ **Models in growing markets**
- ✔ **Models that bring in steady cash**
- ○ One model for every buyer
- ○ Only models in shrinking markets
- ○ Only models with a small share

**Why:** Steady earners pay for the models that will earn in future.

## Task 3

ROUND 2

Three of your models and their markets, sales last year and this year.

**Order by market growth, fastest first?**

PUT THESE IN ORDER, FIRST TO LAST · RIGHT ORDER

1. **5,000 to 6,000 cars**
2. **10,000 to 11,000 cars**
3. **40,000 to 40,800 cars**

**Why:** Growth: 20%, 10%, 2%.

## Task 4

ROUND 2

Your model in its market.

**Market growth, and your share this year?**

WORK OUT THE NUMBER, THEN PICK IT · EXAMPLE FIGURES

| | |
|---|---|
| Market sales last year | **40000 cars** |
| Market sales this year | **50000 cars** |
| Your model's sales this year | **2000 cars** |

METHOD

**Growth = (this year – last year) ÷ last year; share = your sales ÷ market**

(50,000 – 40,000) ÷ 40,000 = 25%; 2,000 ÷ 50,000 = 4%

**Why:** Growth compares with last year; share is of this year's market.

## Task 5

ROUND 3

Your leader in a slow market makes spare cash. A newer model has a small share of a fast market.

**Where should the spare cash go, and why?**

PICK A OR B AND GIVE A REASON

- ○ Back into the leader that earned it
- ✔ **The newer model in the fast market**

**Why:** Cash from a mature leader is best spent building the next winner.

## Task 6

ROUND 3

Your range: a cash cow in a shrinking market, two dogs, and no stars or question marks.

**What is the main risk to the firm?**

PICK ONE

- ○ Negative cash flow today
- ✔ **Nothing to replace the cash cow**
- ○ Stars use up too much cash
- ○ Too many models in growing markets

**Why:** With no stars or question marks, nothing will replace the cash cow when it fades.

# Final questions

| 6 | 109 | 5 |
|---|---|---|
| questions for each pupil | Level 3 Business questions | of them on product portfolio |

**The game draws the 5 questions on this topic, and 1 more from the 109 Level 3 questions.**

1 Research shows range anxiety is the main barrier to a used-EV launch. Which campaign response is most coherent?

**Show verified battery health and real ranges.**

2 A premium campaign promises a two-hour turnaround, but work usually takes four hours. Strongest conclusion?

**The promise is not credible yet.**

3 A model's sales have levelled off, most target customers know it, and rivals offer close alternatives. Which life cycle response is most coherent?

**Defend profitable segments, refresh differentiation or plan replacement on evidence.**

4 A small dealer cannot match a platform's scale but has trusted expertise in wheelchair-accessible vehicles. Most defensible position?

**Focus on the specialist niche.**

5 A dealer has strong electric-vehicle expertise but weak capital reserves. Which strategic choice best uses the evidence?

**A focused EV service niche at small scale.**